Rafael Escobar

Backend-focused software engineer with 10+ years building distributed systems, recently focused on payments and fintech integrations, in Node.js (TS and JS), Go, and C#. Based in Brazil, working remotely. I enjoy picking up new languages and paradigms, and I have a soft spot for Rust and Computing Science.

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in/paemuri

Projects (git)
sr.ht/~paemuri

Skills

Dev
TS/JS, Node.js, Go, Rust, C#

Persistence
PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB

Practices
Microservices, TDD, DDD, OOP, FP

Security
JWT, PCI-DSS

API & Messaging
REST, GraphQL, Kafka

Ops
Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, Datadog, Linux, Shell

Frontend
React, Sass, CSS

Work Experience

TypeScript / Node.js Software Engineer @ Grover

Berlin, Germany / remote | Oct 2021 to current

Grover is a rental service for all tech-related items. I joined the payments team at mid level and was promoted to senior, working in an event-driven microservice environment.

- Helped build the microservice for payment-method management and payment service provider orchestration, all within PCI-DSS scope.
- Shipped its Auth & Capture flow, increasing payment conversion by 12% in its first months, and added new payment methods including Apple Pay and Google Pay.
- Maintain legacy payment logic in the Salesforce monolith.
- Occasionally contribute beyond the team: frontend development, other teams' projects, Kubernetes configuration, and infrastructure management.
- Stack: mainly TypeScript on Node.js, PostgreSQL and Redis for persistence, Kafka for messaging, and AWS (EKS, RDS, Elasticache) managed via Terraform, with CI/CD on GitHub Actions; occasionally handling legacy code in Ruby, vanilla JS, and Apex (Salesforce).
- Use AI coding agents daily (mainly Claude Code) for implementation and code review.

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Go Software Engineer @ Red Ventures
São Paulo, Brazil | Jun 2017 to Sep 2021

Red Ventures is a software consultancy serving multiple clients. I joined at mid level and was promoted to senior.

- Owned the full server side: data modeling, architecture, and cloud infrastructure.
- Worked mostly in Go (sometimes Node.js), with MySQL and Redis, all on AWS (ECS, CloudFront, S3, RDS, Elasticache, Lambda) managed via Terraform, with CI/CD on Jenkins.
- Built authentication in-house: custom certificates and JWT access/refresh tokens written from scratch.

Projects that grew into independent companies:

- Onze: A fintech for private pensions, the first fully online pension provider in Brazil. Required heavy integration work: insurer systems, digital signatures, and anti-money-laundering (AML) checks.
- IQ: A startup that automates bill payments, built from many jobs that integrate with different platforms via APIs or headless browser automation. The most architecturally complex of the three.
- Capital Research: A free financial-publishing consultancy platform.

.NET Software Engineer @ BRQ
São Paulo, Brazil | Apr 2015 to May 2017

At BRQ, I worked mainly with ASP.NET MVC, C#, and MS SQL Server, but some projects required VB, Web Forms, and Oracle. Most clients were large enterprises and banks, and the job usually consisted of legacy code maintenance.

Technical Support @ FIAP
São Paulo, Brazil | Feb 2013 to Apr 2015

Technical support for students and employees of the college, assistance during classes, and computer maintenance during breaks and vacations.

Education

Information Systems BSc @ FIAP
São Paulo, Brazil | 2014 to 2017

Languages

Portuguese
Native

English
Advanced

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